

LEARNER GUIDE

Unit Standard Title: ACCOMMODATE AUDIENCE AND CONTEXT NEEDS IN ORAL/SIGNED COMMUNICATION

Unit Standard No: 119472

Unit Standard Credits: 5

NQF Level: 3

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This material has been compiled based on the **UNIT STANDARD 119472:
ACCOMMODATE AUDIENCE AND CONTEXT NEEDS IN ORAL/SIGNED
COMMUNICATION**

The program has been accredited by SASSETA in the Republic of South Africa.

Material compiled by:

Training Dynamics Africa

PROGRAM GUIDE		5-10
1.	Introduction	5
2.	Purpose of this learning program	5
3.	Standards and qualifications	5
4.	Assessments	6
5.	Range statements	6
6.	The learning guide	6
7.	Learning assumed to be in place	7
8.	Preparation of summative assessment	9
9.	Roles and responsibilities	9
Study unit 1: Interact successfully in oral communication		11-30
1.	Oral communication	13
2.	Group learning	13
3.	The communication model	15
4.	Group dynamics	16
5.	Dynamic areas where oral communication takes place	18
6.	Developing questions	19
7.	Interview problems to avoid	20
8.	Disciplinary interview structure	21
9.	Formal meetings	21
10.	Structure of a formal meeting	22
11.	Structure of a formal debate:	25
12.	Negotiations	26
13.	Register	28
Study unit 2: The use of strategies		31-40
1.	Strategies that capture and retain the interest of an audience	33
2.	Planning	35
3.	Visual aids	36
4.	Continuity and interaction	38
Study unit 3: Manipulative use of language		41-50
1.	Identify and respond to manipulative use of language	43
2.	Guidelines to help keep fact and opinion apart	44
3.	Omission	45

4.	Choice of language structures	46
Glossary of Terms (Educational terms)		51-52
Bibliography		53-54
Unit standard		55-59

1. Introduction

This learning program is part of a complete qualification. For more details concerning the complete qualification please contact your service provider or alternatively the office of the SASSETA

2. Purpose of this learning program

Learners at this level are aware of their audiences and purposes for communication. They adapt their style and language register to the requirements of different situations. They are able to listen and speak/sign confidently in both formal and familiar settings. They can articulate their purposes and reasons for the adoption of a particular register and style in any situation. They can usually identify the assumptions and inferences implicit in what people say/sign and how they say/sign it.

Persons credited with this unit standard are able to:

- ♦ Interact successfully in oral/signed communication.
- ♦ Use strategies that capture and retain the interest of an audience.
- ♦ Identify and respond to manipulative use of language

2.1 Target group

This program is compiled for the following **target group**:

- Security members
- South African Defense Force members
- South African Police Force members
- Correctional Services
- Individuals who wishes to complete the NQF level 3 National Certificate in security practices.

3. Standards and qualifications

It is important that you as the learner understand and realize that this training program is not presented in isolation, but that it was developed based upon nationally recognized standards known as unit standards.

REMEMBER.....

Unit standards are the “building blocks” of qualifications. All qualifications are plotted on the National Qualifications Framework (NQF).

Unit standards comprises of outcomes. An outcome is a statement that describes the required competency that must be demonstrated by the learner on successful completion of a training intervention.

4. Assessments

In order to assess whether a learner can actually demonstrate the desired outcomes, assessment criteria are included in the unit standard. Each outcome has its own set of assessment criteria.

REMEMBER.....

The assessment criteria describe the evidence that is needed that will show that the learner has demonstrated the outcome correctly.

Kindly refer to the unit standard attached hereto for the assessment criteria.

It is of utmost importance that the learner fully understands the assessment criteria as listed in the unit standard, as it is the only way in which the learner will know what he will be assessed against.

The **final or summative assessment** is the most important aspect of this training program. It is during this process that the learner will be declared competent or not yet competent.

The learner will know exactly how he will be assessed, and when and where he will be assessed. All of these details must be obtained from the training provider where the learner enrolled for his program.

5. Range statements

REMEMBER.....

Also included in the unit standard are the range statements in support of the assessment criteria.

The range statements indicate detailed requirements of the assessment criteria.

6. The learning guide

The learner guide is included in this material under various learning units. The learner guide has been designed in such a manner that the learner is guided in a logical way through the learning material and requirements of the unit standard.

On completion of this skill program, the learner will be assessed against the assessment criteria as stipulated in the unit standard.

Each of the modules consists of learner outcomes to be achieved during training and development interventions, work related experience or at your own time. The learner outcomes will enable you to achieve the required level of confidence and competence in order to undergo the summative (final evaluations) assessment.

The learner needs to assess his own knowledge and skill throughout the training process by completing the learner workbook. With the completion of the workbook you start collecting evidence to proof your competence. The learner workbook will be assessed (FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT)

TAKE NOTE

The learner guide will remain the property of the learner once the LEARNING PROGRAM has been completed.

TAKE NOTE

- The best results will be obtained if you start with Study Unit 1 in the Learner Guide, and work your way through it, study unit by study unit.
- All learning outcomes are vital and must be studied (and exercised for all practical requirements) thoroughly to ensure that enough evidence for all specific outcomes is generated.

7. Learning assumed to be in place

It is assumed that a learner which registers for this program have completed a program in communication at NQF Level 3 or equivalent.

It is imperative to understand that this program are only one of the building blocks to complete Skills program 1 The complete list of unit standards for Skills program appears on the next page.

7.1 Security program matrix

SKILLS PROGRAM 1: SASSETA E				Patrol Security officer/Grade E
244177	Conduct a security patrol in area of responsibility	Level 3	7 Credits	
244184	Apply legal aspects in a security environment	Level 3	8 Credits	
244176	Use security equipment	Level 2	2 Credits	
244179	Handle complaints and problems	Level 3	6 Credits	
244181	Perform hand over and take over responsibilities	Level 3	2 Credits	
244182	Give evidence in court	Level 3	4 Credits	
12484	Perform basic fire fighting	Level 2	4 Credits	
116534	Carry out basic first aid treatment in the work-place	Level 3	2 Credits	

SKILLS PROGRAM 2: SASSETA D				Access control officer/Grade D
244189	Conduct access and egress control	Level 4	7 Credits	
242825	Conduct evacuations and emergency drills	Level 4	4 Credits	
11505	Identify, handle and defuse security related conflict	Level 4	12 Credits	
117705	Demonstrate knowledge of the Firearms Control Act 2000 (Act No. 60 of 2000)	Level 3	3 Credits	
113924	Apply basic business ethics in a work environment	Level 2	2 Credits	
119465	Write/present/sign texts for a range of communicative contexts	Level 3	5 Credits	
114979	Operate a computer workstation in a business environment	Level 3	2 Credits	

SKILLS PROGRAM 3: SASSETA C				Asset & reaction officer/Grade C
113909	Coach a team member in order to enhance individual performance in work environment	Level 3	5 Credits	
13912	Apply knowledge of self and team in order to develop a plan to enhance team performance	Level 3	5 Credits	
244578	Describe how to manage reactions arising from a traumatic event	Level 3	2 Credits	
113852	Apply occupational health, safety and environmental principles	Level 3	10 Credits	
13936	Outline the legal environment of a selected industry	Level 3	2 Credits	
119472	Accommodate audience and context needs in oral/signed communication	Level 3	5 Credits	
11508	Write security reports and take statements	Level 4	10 Credits	

8. Preparation of summative assessment

After you have worked through the **LEARNER GUIDE** and you are satisfied that all theoretical and practical requirements/ evidence, as stipulated by the UNIT STANDARD, can be met, you need to make your own necessary arrangements with the assessor and/ or facilitator. The training establishment will then arrange a suitable date for you to attend your pre-assessment meeting and then arrange for a suitable date to complete the final assessment.

8.1 RPL assessment



The assessment of RPL learners will be conducted in the same way as for those of new learners. The assessment pack is exactly the same and will therefore be used for new learners as well as RPL Learners. It must however be noted that learners who are applying for RPL must provide proof of previous learning and subject related experience prior to the assessment.

This proof or evidence can be in the format of certified copies (certificates) of previous learning programs that have been attended.

All the evidence will be assessed and authenticated before a learner will be allowed to enroll for an RPL program.

9. Roles and responsibilities

9.1 Facilitator/instructor

- Prepare to facilitate.
- Transfer of knowledge and skills

9.2 The role of the assessor

- Plan for the assessment
- Prepare the learner for the assessment

9.3 The role of the Learner

- Prepare for assessment.
- Accept the responsibility of learning.
- Accept the responsibility to produce/deliver evidence.

STUDY UNIT 1

Interact successfully in oral communication

LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this study unit the student will....



- ♦ Describe the communication cycle.
- ♦ Interact with any specific audience using the appropriate method of communication.
- ♦ Promote effective communication within a group.
- ♦ Conduct an interview.
- ♦ Participate in a formal meeting.
- ♦ Participate in a debate or negotiations.
- ♦ Use various techniques to re-in force the spoken message.
- ♦ Plan formal communications.
- ♦ Apply verbal and non-verbal communication skills when entering into a conversation and when conversing in writing.
- ♦ Gather and collect and analyse information or unpack information using a method called "brainstorming".
- ♦ Apply relevant communication skills when giving instructions, confirming information, addressing clients, subordinates and senior staff preparing feedback.
- ♦ Interpret and internalize information or repack information using a mind map.

1. Oral communication

Effective oral communication is an important skill in business, academic and scientific endeavour.

Although there are some people who have a natural talent for delivering outstanding presentations, hard work and practice can carry most of the rest of us into the 'very good' level of presentation skills. You will find that presentation skills will benefit you, as they are an essential part of working life.

To interact successfully implies working well in a group. The group process leads to a spirit of co-operation, co-ordination and commonly understood procedures. If this is present within a group of people, then their performance will be enhanced by their mutual support (both practical and moral). Functional groups are ones in which members work effectively to enhance their own and other's learning. Working in a group enables you to:

- ♦ **Develop communication skills:** skills of listening, explaining, questioning, responding -the management of discussion.
- ♦ **Develop intellectual and professional competencies:** analysing; evaluating evidence or data; thinking critically; synthesizing; arguing rationally; transferring skills to new contexts; seeing new relationships and problem-solving.
- ♦ **Personal growth:** development of communication skills; thinking; self-confidence; managing your own learning; working with others and insight into yourself and others.

2. Group learning

The 5 basic elements of group learning:

- ♦ Positive interdependence
- ♦ Individual accountability
- ♦ Promotive interaction (face-to-face)
- ♦ Use of teamwork skills
- ♦ Group processing

"Any attempt to list the qualities of a good manager demonstrates why he (sic) cannot exist ... he must be intelligent, clever, forceful, sensitive to people's feelings, dynamic, patient, decisive and so on. It is extremely difficult to find this jewel among managers ... but if no individual can combine all these qualities, a team of individuals certainly can!"

Belbin, M. (1981:viii) Management Teams: Why They Succeed or Fail? Oxford: BH



How successful/well you interact/work depends on the nature of the task and the nature of the group.

The *nature of the task* has been discussed at length in during the **UNIT STANDARD 119465: WRITE/ PRESENT SIGN TEXTS FOR A RANGE OF COMMUNICATIVE CONTEXTS**. However let us recap.

Why you are communicating falls into four general categories:

- ♦ to provide information
- ♦ to persuade the listener
- ♦ to give instructions
- ♦ to enact (or prohibit) something

Once you have determined the above, together with the actual topic of discussion, you should know exactly what to say.

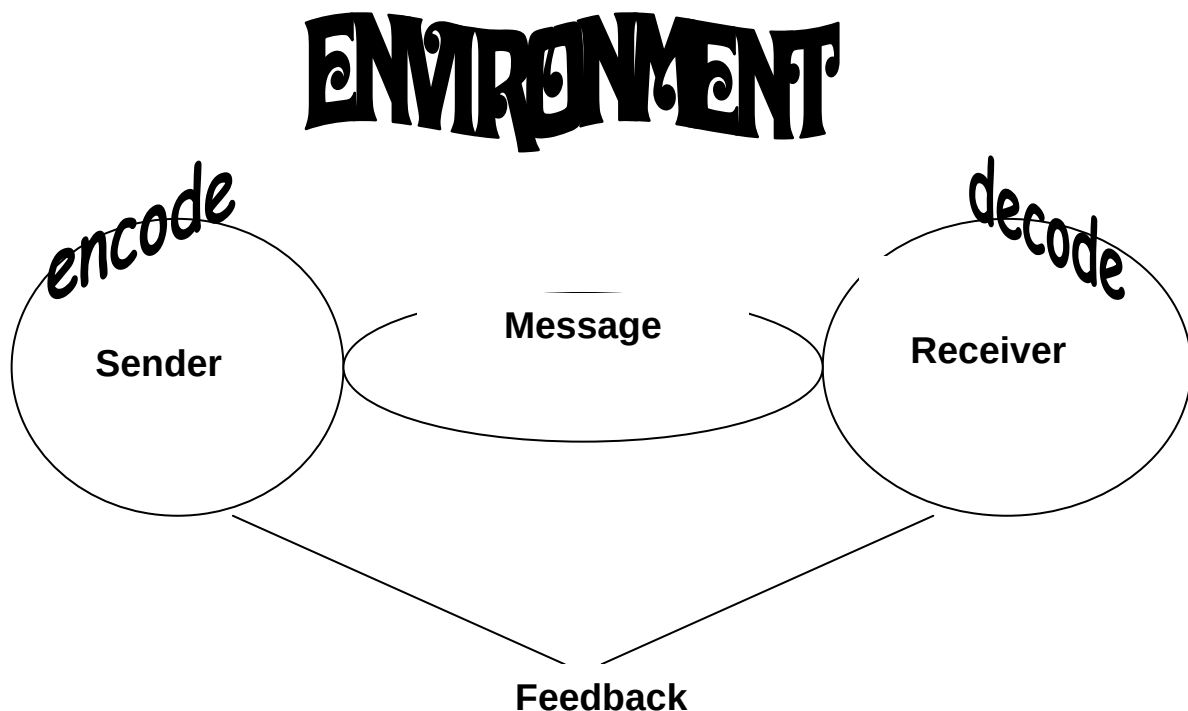
Who you are communicating with is determined by your identification of:

- ♦ listener type and their level of expertise - i.e. are they experts, managers, technicians or laypersons, or a mixed group of listeners
- ♦ listener's purpose in using the information
- ♦ listener's attitude to both you and the content of your presentation

On determining the above, together with knowing what to say, you should know exactly how to say it.

In order for the oral transfer of information to be successful, we need to take some important aspects into consideration:

3. The communication model



There are many factors which influence the communication process, all of which impact each other in a variety of ways.

- ♦ **Sender** - the sender is the speaker/writer. A sender starts with an impulse he or she wishes to express, and then must encode that idea into symbols (words) and signs (facial expressions, tone of voice, etc.).
- ♦ **Message** - the message is the symbols and signs which are actually transmitted. All messages are carried by a channel (face-to-face, over the phone, email, letter, etc.).
- ♦ **Receiver** - the receiver is the listener/reader. The receiver must decode the symbols and signs of the message, sent through the channel. Decoding involves working through one's own perceptual filters, to arrive at thoughts which approximate the sender's original intent.
- ♦ **Feedback** - feedback is the signs the receiver projects while the sender is sending the message. Feedback allows the sender to know how his or her message is being received, and whether the received message is the same as the intended message.
- ♦ **Environment** - environment is the physical, social and emotional influences (often referred to as 'noise'), the communication takes place in. Environments can place expectations and/or constraints on communication.

In looking at the above communication model, we must understand that the environment or 'noise' factor plays a larger role when it comes to oral communication.

The reason for this, is that a person *listening* to another person, is far more easily distracted than a person *reading* something.



- ♦ when other people are talking nearby while you are listening to someone, you often 'eavesdrop' on their conversation and miss what is being said to you
- ♦ when music is playing nearby, you often listen to that, instead of what is being said to you
- ♦ when you see something interesting/funny/or a person nearby, you focus on that instead of on what is being said to you.

We can see from the above that it is vital to focus/pay attention, when wanting to receive oral information successfully.

4. Group dynamics

When people work in groups, there are two quite separate issues involved.

- ♦ **The first is the task** and the problems involved in getting the job done. Often this is the only issue which the group considers.
- ♦ **The second is the process** of the group work itself: the mechanisms by which the group acts as a unit. If both the task and the process issues are well managed, the worth of the group could be many times the sum of the worth of its individuals.

Therefore, successful group dynamics are just as important as the final presentation.

The following information is designed to help you make the most of group work:

Meetings:

- ♦ The place for groups to make decisions is in a meeting. Once the group is set up and assigned a task it should:
 - ♦ have an early first meeting
 - ♦ meet regularly
 - ♦ let everyone have a say

Planning: To divide up a task between a group of people and deliver it to a schedule requires a plan. Planning can be formal or informal - a formal plan makes deadlines and responsibilities clear. For a group work presentation:

- ♦ make a plan
- ♦ assign clear responsibilities
- ♦ set deadlines
- ♦ monitor progress at the meetings
- ♦ do fair shares of the work

Group/Individual Tasks: Divide up your project into group and individual tasks. Groups are best at:

- ♦ generating ideas
- ♦ making plans
- ♦ checking and agreeing outputs

Individual work is most suited to:

- ♦ **discussion leader**: keeps group on track; maintains full participation
- ♦ **Recorder**: records assignments, strategies, unresolved issues, data; convenes group outside of class
- ♦ **Reporter**: reports out during whole class discussion; writes up final draft of assignments
- ♦ **accuracy coach**: checks group understanding; finds resources

Further Points:

- ♦ keep copies of work (someone else may lose it)
- ♦ report any insurmountable difficulties to your leader
- ♦ get the job done on time

Therefore, the main determinants of group effectiveness are:

- ♦ Equal distribution of work
- ♦ Efficient management and control of work
- ♦ Brainstorming - gathering ideas, information and suggestions
- ♦ Ground rules - e.g. - come to class on time everyday
 - ⇒ come to class prepared/with work completed
 - ⇒ notify group in event of absence
 - ⇒ be willing to share information
 - ⇒ respect the views, values and ideas of other members of the group
- ♦ Resolution of disagreements



INTERPRETATION

Groups are like relationships - you have to work at them.

!

The individual's talents are better utilized in a group.

5. Dynamic areas where oral communication takes place

5.1 Interviews

Companies do not interview every job applicant, they pre-screen. If you do not meet the preliminary qualifications, you are not interviewed.

Some jobs that require interviews:

- ♦ jobs working with the public
- ♦ jobs answering telephones
- ♦ jobs where special skills are needed (accounting, finance, banking)

Some jobs that would not require interviews:

- ♦ digging ditches
- ♦ pruning trees
- ♦ digging graves

In order for an interview to flow smoothly, it has to be carefully planned:

The venue: The venue should be quiet (away from traffic and other noise, especially people who could cause a distraction) and comfortable (chairs should be soft and comfortable and there should be something pleasant to look at e.g. flowers or a good painting). This is the ideal situation, but in reality it often cannot happen. It is then that the interviewer has to be flexible and make do with the given circumstances. A good interviewer will be able to conduct a successful interview, irrespective of the circumstances!

Background research: It is generally accepted that the more interviewee data can be gathered before the interview, the more reliable and easier the interview will be. Prepare for the interview by reviewing the application, resume (CV), test results and other materials submitted by the candidate. It is also imperative that the interviewer has extensive knowledge about the environment, its people and their jobs. He needs to know what is happening and what could happen in future.

Thorough research about the interviewee serves three purposes:

- ♦ because the interviewer knows all the 'superficial' facts, he can focus on underlying problems, without having to do additional research
- ♦ the interviewer does not waste time with unnecessary questions
- ♦ it supplies guidelines as to the types of questions that need to be asked

The interview: A structured interview will prevent confusion and repetition on the side of the interviewee as well as the interviewer. It is, however, necessary to be flexible, depending on the circumstances. The amount of structure will be determined by the type of interview. Questions need to be planned and ordered in a meaningful way. Put the interviewee at ease and ask interview questions that cannot be answered with a "yes" or a "no" response. Open-ended questions allow interviewees to tell about their skills, knowledge and abilities.



e.g. "Why are you leaving your current employer?"

"Do you prefer routine, consistent work, or fast-paced tasks that change daily?" "And why?"

Final preparation: The interviewer must prepare himself mentally and block out any thoughts that are not relevant to the interview. He must make sure that he is not biased and that he will assess the interviewee on their merits.

Background research, the interview and final preparation should assure that the conclusions drawn are correct and fair.

6. Developing questions

Descriptive:

- ♦ does something need to be described? E.g. "How do graduates of the XYZ program for the unemployed
- ♦ seek out and find jobs in the community?"

Normative:

- ♦ does something need to be compared? E.g. "How well
- ♦ does the program meet its goals for placing graduates in jobs?"

Impact: (cause + effect)

- ♦ has something made a difference? E.g. "Why do some graduates find jobs and others do not find jobs?"

There are different ways of asking the same thing :

EXAMPLE:

to determine age:

- ♦ "How old were you on your last birthday?" OR
- ♦ "On what day, month and year were you born?"

Both questions help you determine the individual's age, but the second question elicits much more information.

7. Interview problems to avoid

- ♦ Be familiar with topics that aren't permissible as interview questions.

EXAMPLE:

don't ask a female applicant detailed questions about her husband /children and family plans.

It could be used as proof of sex-discrimination if a male applicant is selected.

- ♦ Avoid making statements during the interview process that could be alleged to create a contract of employment.

EXAMPLE:

terms like "permanent", "career job opportunity" or "long term".

- ♦ Avoid making excessive assurances about job security unless the employer can prove that he did not do a good job.

EXAMPLE:

the applicant is told "if you do a good job, there's no reason why you can't work here for the rest of your career". The applicant accepts the job and six months later is laid off due to personnel cutbacks, which he refuses to accept,

8. Disciplinary interview structure

Disciplinary and grievance interviews occur when either the employer or the employee has a cause for complaint against the other. They take place in a quasi-legal framework according to internally documented procedures designed to comply with legislation.

8.1 Rules for the interviewing manager conducting a disciplinary interview

- ♦ must be very clear about the reasons for the interview
- ♦ must articulate the reasons to the employee
- ♦ must ensure that investigations are conducted as quickly as possible
- ♦ must give clear and unambiguous warnings (verbal or written)
- ♦ must state clearly what the employee is expected to do to rectify the situation
- ♦ must follow the internal procedure
- ♦ must keep records of the interview and any actions arising

8.2 Structure

Opening:

- ♦ Tone: the interviewer should be in control of the interview at all times.

Discussion:

- ♦ **Explaining:** explain clearly the reasons for this interview, nature of complaint and company policy; refer to company procedures.
- ♦ **Listening:** allow the employee to tell his/her version of the facts or to offer mitigating circumstances.
- ♦ **Outlining:** explain what will happen next, the exact nature of warning the warning you are giving and the consequences.

Conclusion:

- ♦ **Agree:** ensure that the employee has understood the understanding warning, the implications and what he/she has to do next.
- ♦ **close out:** terminate the interview and record it according to procedures

9. Formal meetings

It is important to remember that matters discussed at a meeting can only be legally effective and binding if the following legal requirements have been met:

- ♦ the meeting must be properly convened. Notices must reach the members in accordance with the constitution of the organization.
- ♦ the meeting must be properly constituted. The right person must be in the chair, and there must be a quorum; in other words, the minimum number of members entitled to vote, must be present.

All types of meetings are subject to:

- ♦ the country's laws or statutes
- ♦ the organisation's constitution
- ♦ the common law
- ♦ the organisation's own customs and practices

Formal meetings are made up of *private meetings* and *public meetings*.

9.1 Private meetings

Only members are entitled to be present at private meetings. Sometimes an outsider is allowed to attend such a meeting as an observer, but he does not have the right to vote.



The following organisations, for example, hold private meetings:

- ♦ Companies with limited liability
- ♦ Bodies such as church, school or city councils
- ♦ Bodies such as private clubs or associations

9.2 Public meetings

These include the following:

- ♦ Conferences
- ♦ Symposiums
- ♦ Seminars
- ♦ political meetings
- ♦ national meetings

Such meetings are advertised in the media or by mail, and are attended by the public at large. The conveners usually appoint the chairman and the meeting then proceeds according to its usual custom.

10. Structure of a formal meeting

Booking the venue: Book the venue well in advance, keeping in mind the requirements of the meeting.



e.g. number of people attending, equipment used for presentations, etc.

Preparation: simplify your arrangements as much as possible, by getting the logistics right

EXAMPLE:

, e.g. tables and chairs, lighting, stationery, name badges/stickers, programs/agendas, water jugs and glasses.

Notice of a meeting: The timing and the form required is very important. Don't send the notices out too early, people forget easily and the notices may lose their effectiveness.

REMEMBER.....

Remember the following points when sending out notices - who, what, when, where and why. Make "when" very clear by stating day, date and hour.

Agenda: The agenda is a list of matters to be discussed at a meeting in a specific order. The chairman may only change the order with the meeting's consent.

Notes: Jot down only the most important points. Make a note of all the changes to the minutes.

The minutes: These are a report of the decisions made at the meeting. They are the official historical record of an organization.



10. Discussions, debates or negotiations

10.1 Discussion

DEFINITION

A *discussion* is to have a conversation about, or consider by talking over, a specific topic/s.

Here are 10 discussion techniques:

1. asking someone for their opinion about a topic
2. delaying strategies
3. presenting a number of arguments
4. giving your opinion about a topic
5. agreeing - completely or conditionally
6. disagreeing
7. countering
8. logical argument
9. clarification
10. expressing solutions and alternatives

IMPORTANT

Discussions can be formal or informal and can play a very important part in the communication in an organisation.

10.2 Debate

DEFINITION

A *debate* is a formal discussion in which opposing arguments are put forward. It includes persuasion, which appeals to the emotional responses of an audience. The outcome of a debate may be decided by audience vote, by judges, or by some combination of the two.

IMPORTANT

A debate can be informal or formal.

Informal debate has a number of advantages:

- ♦ Debating reflects the learning process. Debate establishes extremes, allowing the viewers and participants to see the areas in between more clearly.
- ♦ Debating allows students to explore ideas and arguments in a non-threatening atmosphere, because presentational guidelines are provided.
- ♦ Debating is an effective method of acquiring knowledge, as arguments need to be supported by relevant, accurate, and complete information.
- ♦ Students who debate informally learn to recognize the elements of a good argument and to develop further their abilities to speak confidently.

11. Structure of a formal debate:



A debate is about a topic, usually called the moot. The moot is a claim that something is true.



- ♦ That South Africa needs a well-equipped airforce.
- ♦ That the school system benefits all students who choose to work hard.
- ♦ That space exploration is a waste of time.
- ♦ That New Zealand's population is too small.

There are two teams with three speakers each. One team agrees with the moot (the Affirmative) and the other team disagrees (the Negative).

Usually you are given the topic and told whether your team is affirmative or negative. This means you may be debating a position you personally don't agree with. This is the skill of debating, and it helps you understand that there are two sides to most questions.

11.1 Affirmative and Negative

Each team divides up the job of researching the evidence and preparing the case. Each team member writes speech notes. The first people to speak use their notes more, while the later speakers will be answering what their opponents have said (rebuttal).

The teams speak in this order:

1.	Affirmative leader	Define moot, introduction
2.	Negative leader	
3.	Affirmative second speaker	Further arguments
4.	Negative second speaker	
5.	Affirmative third speaker	Mostly rebuttal
6.	Negative third speaker	
7.	Negative leader	Summary (no new arguments)
8.	Affirmative leader	

Purpose

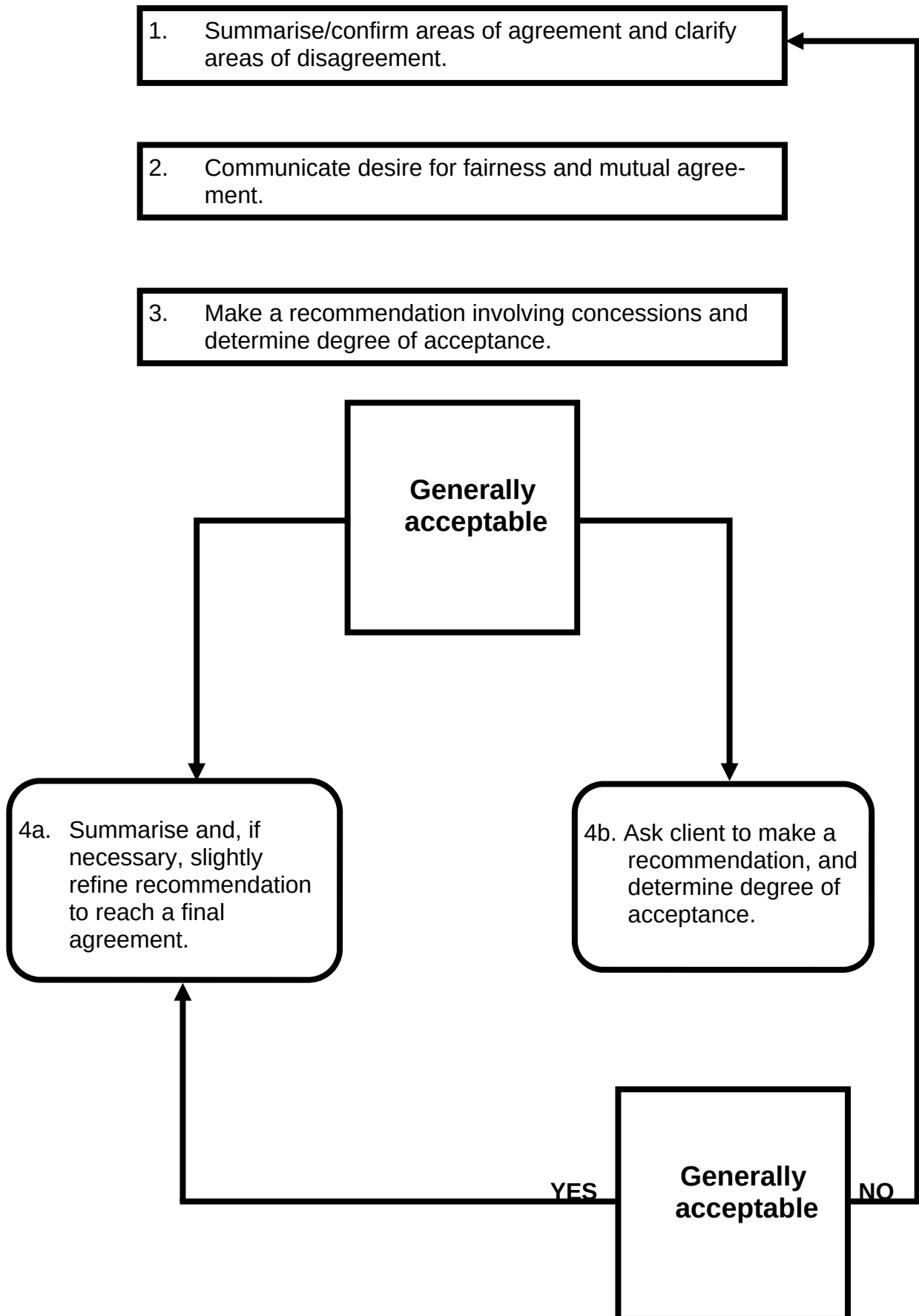
What is the point of the debate? Each team is trying to win by doing the best job of arguing their case. This does not mean that one team must be right and the other one wrong. There are two sides to any debate, and either side could win.

12. Negotiations

Broadly speaking, *negotiation* is an interaction of influences. Such interactions, for example, include the process of resolving disputes, agreeing upon courses of action, bargaining for individual or collective advantage, or crafting outcomes to satisfy various interests. Negotiation is thus a form of alternative dispute resolution.

Negotiation involves three basic elements: *process*, *behavior* and *substance*. The *process* refers to how the parties negotiate: the context of the negotiations, the parties to the negotiations, the tactics used by the parties, and the sequence and stages in which all of these play out. *Behaviour* refers to the relationships among these parties, the communication between them and the styles they adopt. The *substance* refers to what the parties negotiate over: the agenda, the issues (positions and - more helpfully - interests), the options, and the agreement(s) reached at the end.

NEGOTIATION MODEL



As can be seen from the model on the previous page, these three communication tools (discussion, debate and negotiation) are of great importance in an organisation, and their use will be determined by the topic and the circumstances/situation.

13. Register

Register reflects the situation and determines the most appropriate language. Socio-cultural sensitivities must be kept in mind, so that offensive language is not used. Own values or arguments must, however, not be compromised in doing so.

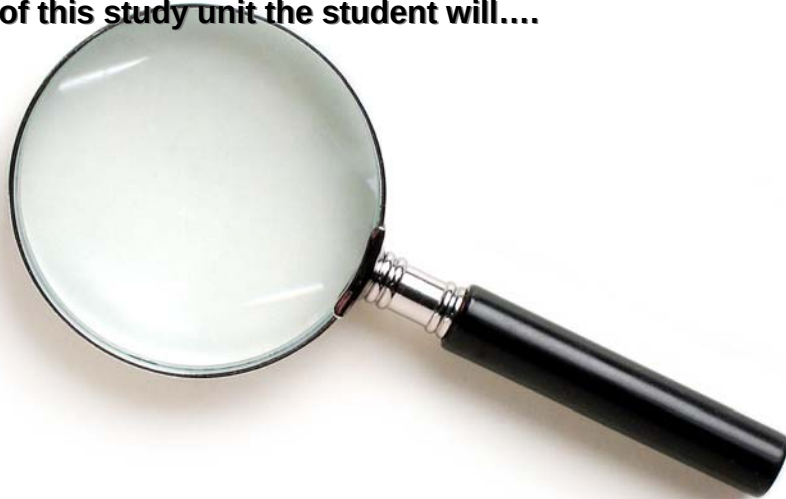
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STUDY UNIT 2

The use of strategies

LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this study unit the student will....



- ◆ Discuss visual aids.
- ◆ Apply techniques to maintain continuity and interaction during a presentation.
- ◆ Describe how a point of view is shaped through choice of language.

1. Strategies that capture and retain the interest of an audience

The material of your presentation should be concise, to the point and tell an interesting story. In addition to the obvious things like content and visual aids, the following are just as important, as the audience will be subconsciously taking them in:

Your voice: How you say it is as important as what you say. Throughout your presentation, try to convey your enthusiasm and belief in the topic.

The use of your voice establishes.....

- ♦ rapport,
- ♦ maintains interest,
- ♦ emphasizes points and assists comprehension of the information by the audience.

This can be achieved by **THE FOLLOWING:**

- ♦ varying volume,
- ♦ pace,
- ♦ pitch,
- ♦ pause and
- ♦ tone.

Talk at a moderate pace if you have excellent content. If your arguments are weak, speak at a faster pace as this will give people less chance for developing counter arguments. Fast talkers are regarded as more competent, truthful, fluent, energetic, enthusiastic and persuasive. By talking fast, you move the attention from the content to yourself. This being said, it is important to match your pace to what needs to be said - important instructions or explanations need to be presented at a moderate pace, whilst general information could be presented at a faster pace.



Use a quiet, reasonable tone for the content, but still show some energy and interest. Pauses of two seconds before key points are recommended to create interest and attention in what follows. Pauses after key points allow people to reflect on what was said.

Body language: Your body movements express what your attitudes and thoughts really are. Your movements attract attention and give the audience something to follow. The following tips can assist you.

- ♦ If you have been standing still or behind a podium, move to the right or left or toward the audience.
- ♦ Use gestures to emphasize a point.
- ♦ Facial expressions also help to convey a message.
- ♦ Maintain eye contact and don't forget to smile!



Appearance: First impressions influence the audience's attitudes to you. Dress appropriately for the occasion and to show you respect the audience.



TAKE NOTE

As with most personal skills, oral communication cannot be taught. So as always, practice is essential, both to improve your skills generally and also to make the best of each individual or group presentation you make.

2. Planning

Initial Planning: This is where you begin to tailor the talk to the situation, and for that reason, this stage is very important for a successful presentation.

Begin this stage early, the more lead time you allow yourself, the more time you will have to think up potential approaches to the topic and the more interesting and substantial your presentation will be.

Before you begin preparing the presentation, you'll need to determine:

The type of talk you'll be expected to give:

- ♦ Will this be an informal chat, a seminar discussion, or a more formal presentation?
- ♦ Different talks have different purposes.

The composition of the audience

- ♦ Will you be speaking to a general audience or specialists?
- ♦ How many people are expected to attend?

The time allotted for the talk

- ♦ The longer the talk, the more freedom you will have to explore the topic.
- ♦ A short talk needs to be very clear and to address the topic directly.
- ♦ Let your audience know that you regard *their* time as precious and have no intention of wasting it.
- ♦ Keep to your allotted time - do not extend it and do not keep rambling on just to fill your time slot. "If you haven't struck oil in five minutes - stop boring!"

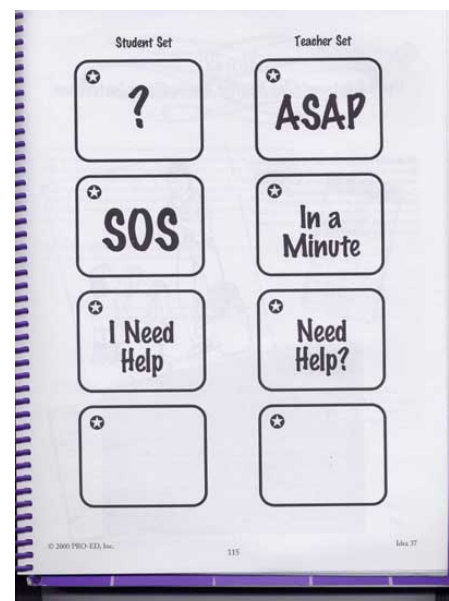
Expectations for information content

- ♦ What is the purpose of your talk? Clarify the expectations beforehand and plan to address them during the presentation.
- ♦ Will you be presenting novel concepts to this audience, or building upon their prior knowledge? Either way, make sure you cover the basics clearly, and early in the talk, to avoid confusing the audience.

3. Visual aids

Visual aids enhance the presentation, the transfer of information and the understanding thereof. They do, however, have to be appropriate to the topic and the context.

Cue cards: These are a visual aid for you, the presenter. The notes must be written boldly, in print not script, and must list key words only. The cards must fit in the palm of your hand.

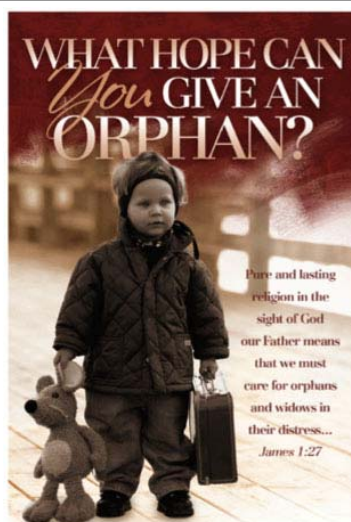


Handouts: Do not hand out material to read when you begin the presentation:

- It may cause the listeners to get out of step with the speaker, unless the handout contains information that needs to be referred to during the presentation.

The purpose of this material is to:

- Convey information more clearly and concisely than can be transferred orally.

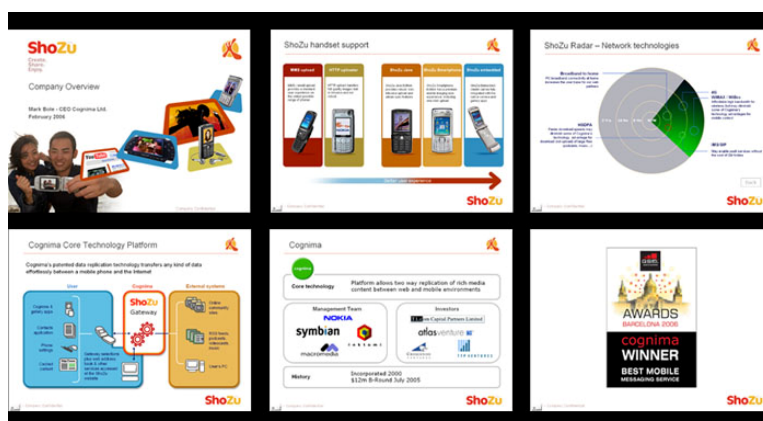


Do not include anything that is unnecessary. All tables, charts, graphs, maps and diagrams should be made simple and as clear as possible. Too much detail will make them difficult to understand.

It is a good idea to include your references on a handout, so that people can follow up on them later. A paper record (handout) tells your audience that you are serious, responsible, exact and credible. It gives the audience something they can read, take away, make copies of and refer to at a later stage.

Multi-media and visual aids: PowerPoint presentations, transparencies, or flip charts can help people follow the talk. This is especially important to show organisation, present lists, highlight illustrations and exhibits, and summarise data. People think in pictures. Say Nike and people "see" the swoosh. Say Energiser and people "see" the bunny. Say (your name hear) and what do people see? That is why logos and other graphical elements are so important. Tapping into the visualization part of the brain is probably the most powerful way to communicate with anyone. When putting together a PowerPoint presentation, keep the following in mind:

- key words on bullet points - this helps to retain audience attention and gives you a reason for being there (anyone can read, so you do not want to read to them).
- omit anything that is not vital. PowerPoint often leads people to include irrelevant things (only if you have nothing important to say, should you use lots of bells and whistles).
- only use colour when the colour has a meaning. Keep in mind that some people are colour-blind and others may make black and white copies of the slides, in which case the colour would be meaningless.



4. Continuity and interaction

Continuity and interaction are vital for a successful presentation. It is imperative that the speaker/presenter be very well prepared. This will ensure a smooth presentation and good timing. It will allow the speaker to pick up on any confused or perplexed listeners, as well as check understanding by asking questions. If questions and answers follow your presentation,



remember to always repeat the question for the entire audience.

Then look at the questioner when answering. If you are unsure, don't make up an answer, rather say you don't know and say you need to get back to them.

[illegible]

STUDY UNIT 3

Manipulative use of language

LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this study unit the student will....



- ♦ Identify the manipulative use of language.
- ♦ Analyse the meaning of the text.
- ♦ Distinguish between fact and opinion.

1. Identify and respond to manipulative use of language

Humans all over the world tend to be manipulative beings. They achieve this through acts, but mostly through their choice of words.

DEFINITION

To manipulate means to control or influence something or someone cleverly, deviously or skillfully, often for one's own advantage.

A person can say the same sentence twice, but using a different body language or tone of voice the second time, and the listener/receiver of the message will receive two very different messages. E.g. "sit down" said in a gentle, kind manner, would make a person feel comfortable and nurtured, while "sit down!" shouted in an unfriendly way, would make a person feel nervous and expect trouble.

In the same way, a person can manipulate others by 'confusing' facts and opinions, by selective omission of necessary information and by subtly forcing their own point of view onto them.

In order to avoid the above, one needs to be able to identify and distinguish facts and opinions.

DEFINITION

Fact: A statement of actuality or occurrence.

A fact is based on direct evidence, actual experience, or observation. A fact is a statement that can be proven true.

EXAMPLE:

- ♦ The Empire State Building is 1250 feet tall.
- ♦ Michael Jordan was born on 17 February 1963.

DEFINITION

Opinion: A statement of belief or feeling.

An opinion expresses someone's belief, feeling, view, idea, or judgment about something or someone.

EXAMPLE:

The puppy is cute.
Mercedes makes the best car in the world.

2. Guidelines to help keep fact and opinion apart

Opinion ...	Fact ...
- does the author/speaker use words that interpret or label, such as: pretty; ugly; safe; dangerous; evil; attractive; well-dressed; good; and so on? - are there words that clue you to statements of opinion such as: probably; perhaps; usually; often; sometimes; on occasion; I believe; I think; in my opinion; I feel; I suggest; and so on? - can you identify differing opinions and their effect on the author's/speaker's views? - does the truth of the premise depend on us accepting a certain definition of key words or concepts? Has the author/speaker defined the conditions for using the concepts?	- can the fact be verified by direct observation? - can the facts be trusted? How did the author/speaker come to the facts? - does the author/speaker have the skill and experience to make such a statement? - are the facts presented in an objective manner? (any bias evident or suspected?) - does the author/speaker make clear the sources of statements from authorities? Are these authorities reliable? - can the study which generates the facts be duplicated? - are the facts relevant to the point being made? - have unfavorable or negative points been left out? (are there counter-studies?) - do the facts prove the claim being made or do they merely suggest that the claim is reasonable?

REMEMBER

Remember that your acceptance of an author's/speaker's opinion or claim depends on your own view of the subject and of the writer's/speaker's work. To help evaluate an author's/speaker's ideas, you need a clear understanding of your own opinions.

EXAMPLE:

"Registration and control of firearms in Canada is not supported by the Canadian public, and will not lead to a decrease in gun-related crime" The underlined statement is a fact. The statement in italics is an opinion.

There is nothing wrong with mixing opinions and fact together in an argument. What is important is that the reader be able to **distinguish the fact from the opinion**, in order to make a sound judgment about the information they are receiving.

TAKE NOTE

3. Omission

Just as opinions disguised as facts can mislead and manipulate readers/listeners, the *omission* of important/necessary information can do the same.

A classic example of the consequences of omission, is when getting a recipe from someone! How often does a person not really want to share their culinary secrets with you, but is obliged to do so. In order for their dish/end product still to be the best, they leave out a specific ingredient, or a specific part of the method, which is vital to the success of the recipe.

Another example, which can have far reaching consequences and occurs regularly in the workplace, is when a subordinate becomes a threat to his/her superior. It is the superior's duty to lead by example and also to teach/assist the subordinate when necessary. As soon as the superior realises his/her position is in danger, he/she omits necessary information, which then makes the subordinate look bad when things go wrong that he/she has done. If management does not pick up on this, it buys the superior time and sometimes favour.

Often people do not realise that necessary information has been omitted, because they do not have sufficient knowledge about the topic. In order to try and avoid this, it is necessary to get confirmation that your understanding is correct. It is also advisable to be aware of any negative attitudes that might be present.

When attending a talk or presentation, it is difficult to judge whether necessary information is being omitted. It is therefore necessary to check the reliability of the information by discussing it with other audience members - often some of them have sufficient knowledge on the topic.

4. Choice of language structures

One of the easiest ways to manipulate people is by the choice of language structures and features, such as tone, register, style and point of view. These have been looked at before, but need to be recapped.

- ♦ **Register** reflects the situation and determines the most appropriate language. Socio-cultural sensitivities must be kept in mind, so that offensive language is not used. Own values or arguments must, however, not be compromised in doing so.
- ♦ **Style** is the manner in which a writer addresses a matter, a manner which reveals the writer's personality, or 'voice'.
- ♦ **Tone** is the sound of your voice, with reference to quality, pitch and volume.
- ♦ **Point of view** is your mental viewpoint or attitude.

Listen for tone, attitude, and clarity. Is the tone you project appropriate for your audience and your purpose? Is each sentence easy to understand? Are you speaking too rapidly? Are the major divisions in your presentation easy to hear? Are any sentences difficult to understand?

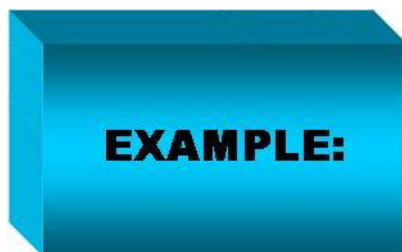
By looking at the above, it is easy to see how it can be used to manipulate an audience - positively or negatively.

The best examples of manipulation using language, are found in the advertising world and political speeches.

#X i p tbtz zpv bffe bjsujn f up ubml @#

As soon as you read this, you think free calls! Whether you intended phoning someone or not, you start thinking of the possibilities, because you might not need airtime to do so. *You have been manipulated!* You are doing exactly what Vodacom wanted you to do, i.e. think about phoning someone.

The rest of the advertisement reads as follows:



"Introducing Vodacom Reverse Charge. Simply dial 082 180 + the full number of the person you need to reach. Now all Vodacom contract customers can accept call charges from any Vodacom customer."

By reading the rest of the advertisement, you realise that you cannot phone for free - someone is still going to pay for it, even if it is not you. Vodacom did not lie to you by promising free talk time, they just manipulated you with their choice of words.



"Live in the spirit of Africa. Africa. The Serengeti - a place where your spirit can soar above endless, rolling grasslands."

Add to this a beautiful picture of a sunset over a plain with the silhouette of just one thorn tree, and you are transported to another world, free of stress and problems. Just the place most people would like to be!

The beginning of this advertisement has already manipulated your thoughts. You think of your present situation and often become disillusioned with it, or you start planning for something that you would love, but can't really afford.

On reading the rest of the advertisement, you find a wonderful lifestyle that is out of reach for most of the population:



"This is what you'll find once you secure a lifestyle at Serengeti Golf and Wildlife Estate. Within this 780ha estate you will not only find peace and tranquillity, but also a range of facilities for the whole family to enjoy: ..."

These are two examples where nothing wrong or dishonest has been done, but by clever use of language, have managed to manipulate the reader into thinking of previously insignificant things.

The following extracts are from remarks by *President George W Bush* to teachers and students at *Townsend Elementary School in Townsend, Tennessee, on 21 February 2001*.

"Yesterday I also outlined some funding priorities of mine. I'm going to submit a budget next week to the United States Congress -- it's a budget that sets clear priorities. A priority is going to be to make sure that our Social Security system and the payroll taxes are saved for Social Security and the Social Security system is strong. A priority would be Medicare. A priority is going to be to make sure our troops are well-paid and well-housed and well-trained, so that we can keep the peace. A priority is going to be pay down debt. A priority is going to be tax relief, so hardworking Americans have got more money in their pocket to pay down their own debt and to cover the cost of high energy costs."

We can see in the first extract that President Bush was telling the teachers and students what they wanted to hear. His style and register was appropriate to his audience, which would most likely ensure their support for him.

In the second extract he spreads his manipulation even wider, to include the rest of the population. He addresses the Social Security System, which provides for the poor; he addresses salaries, housing and training for the troops; he addresses tax relief - which will affect the whole population. By his clever use of language, he manages to win the support of millions of people.

In the following extract from '*Distortion of Fact*' by Andrew Burfield, we can see how the omission of vital information can distort the whole picture. The Commission had reported that there were nineteen hijackers, all of whom had died in the attack.

DEFINITION

To distort means to alter or misinterpret facts, or to twist or pull out of shape.

EXAMPLE:

"The omission of evidence that at least six of the alleged hijackers — including Waleed al-Shehri, said by the Commission probably to have stabbed a flight attendant on Flight 11 before it crashed into the North Tower of the WTC — are still alive."

The above extract clearly illustrates how the credibility of "the Commission" is affected and the whole picture distorted, by the omission of credible reports that provide the necessary proof that those people are still alive.

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

WORDS/ACRONYMS	EXPLANATION OF ACRONYMS
ASSESSMENT	"A structured process of gathering evidence and making judgments about an individual's performance in relation to registered national standards and qualifications"
ASSESSMENT CRITERIA	It describe the evidence that is needed to show that the learner has demonstrated the outcome correctly. A list of evidence to be supplied by the candidate as proof of his / her ability to integrate all of the competencies listed earlier in the standard.
COMPETENCE	Competence is the ability to do certain things in a range of different environments with knowledge and understanding about what is being done and the effect this has on others. It includes <u>Knowledge, skills, attitudes, values and ethics.</u>
CREDIT	Each unit standard is worth a number of credits which gives an indication of the size and scope of the unit standard, the standard is worth. (1 credit = 10 notional hours of learning)
CRITICAL CROSSFIELD OUTCOMES	critical cross field outcomes is to direct educational activities towards development of the learners within a social and economic environment.
EMBEDDED KNOWLEDGE	Body of theory essential for understanding and applying the standard. Principles, methods and techniques that would underpin good practice of this unit standard.
EVIDENCE	Evidence is a set of information or observations that provides proof of the learner's competence.
FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT	Aims to assist the learner to identify any knowledge/skills gaps when demonstrating his/her current competence. Diagnostic assessment supports learning and progress of the learner.
INTEGRATED ASSESSMENT	Integrated assessment refers to: • assessing a number of outcomes together • assessing a number of assessment criteria together • assessing a number of unit standards together • using a combination of assessment methods and instruments for an outcome/s • collecting naturally occurring evidence in the workplace • Acquiring evidence from other sources such as supervisor's reports, testimonials, portfolio of work previously done, logbooks, journals etc.
LEARNING ASSUMED TO BE IN PLACE	Building blocks (knowledge, skill and understanding) assumed to be in place
LEARNING PROGRAM	A "learning program is a set of learning activities in which the learner will be involved in working towards the achievement of one or more outcomes.
LEVEL	Each unit standard is registered on the NQF at a particular level based on the complexity of the outcomes and stringency of the standards.
NQF	National Qualifications Framework
RANGE STATEMENTS	The range statements indicate detailed requirements of the assessment criteria.

RE-ASSESSMENT	• The same method and instrument may be used, but, the task and materials should be different • The task and materials should, however, be of the same complexity and level as the previous ones. • In case the methods and instruments are changed it must be ensured that they are appropriate for the outcomes specified.
RPL ASSESSMENT	RPL is a way of recognizing what individuals already know and can do. The basic premise underlying it is that people, especially mature adults, learn many things inside and outside the formal structures of education and training and that irrespective of where, how and when learning was acquired, subject to assessment, it can be worthy of recognition and credit.
RPL	Recognition of prior learning
SASSETA	Safety & security sector education and training authority.
SAQA	SOUTH AFRICAN QUALIFICATION AUTHORITY
SPECIFIC OUTCOMES	An outcome is a statement that describes the required competency that must be demonstrated by the learner on successful completion of a training intervention. Key performance areas in the standard are given, the focus is <i>not</i> only on current competence, but also on future competence in this standard.
SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT	Assessment used to record the level of competence achieved by a learner over a period of time, e.g. at the end of a program, term or year.
QUALIFICATIONS	Represent a planned combination of learning outcomes which has a defined purpose and intended to provide learners with applied competence and a basis for further learning
UNIT STANDARDS	the “building blocks” of qualifications. All qualifications are plotted on the National Qualifications Framework (NQF). “A statement of the outcomes that the learner must achieve to earn credit. Standards are nationally agreed and internationally comparable.”

Accommodate audience and context needs in oral/signed communication

SAQA US ID		UNIT STANDARD TITLE	
119472		Accommodate audience and context needs in oral/signed communication	
ORIGINATOR		REGISTERING PROVIDER	
SGB GET/FET Language and Communication			
FIELD		SUBFIELD	
Field 04 - Communication Studies and Language		Language	
ABET BAND	UNIT STANDARD TYPE	NQF LEVEL	CREDITS
Undefined	Regular-Fundamental	Level 3	5
REGISTRATION STATUS	REGISTRATION START DATE	REGISTRATION END DATE	SAQA DECISION NUMBER
Registered	2006-02-09	2009-02-09	SAQA 0264/06
LAST DATE FOR ENROLMENT		LAST DATE FOR ACHIEVEMENT	
2010-02-09		2013-02-09	

PURPOSE OF THE UNIT STANDARD

Learners at this level are aware of their audiences and purposes for communication. They adapt their style and language register to the requirements of different situations. They are able to listen and speak/sign confidently in both formal and familiar settings. They can articulate their purposes and reasons for the adoption of a particular register and style in any situation. They can usually identify the assumptions and inferences implicit in what people say/sign and how they say/sign it.

Persons credited with this unit standard are able to:

- Interact successfully in oral/signed communication
- Use strategies that capture and retain the interest of an audience
- Identify and respond to manipulative use of language

LEARNING ASSUMED TO BE IN PLACE AND RECOGNITION OF PRIOR LEARNING

The credit calculation is based on the assumption that learners are already competent in terms of the following outcomes or areas of learning when starting to learn towards this unit standard: the NQF Level 2 unit standard, entitled Maintain and adapt oral/signed communication.

UNIT STANDARD RANGE

The learner can engage in oral/signed interactions in a variety of formal and informal contexts in socio-cultural, learning and workplace situations.

Specific range statements are provided in the body of the unit standard where they apply to particular specific outcomes or assessment criteria.

UNIT STANDARD OUTCOME HEADER

N/A

Specific Outcomes and Assessment Criteria:

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 1

Interact successfully in oral/signed communication.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1

Contributions to group work are appropriate to the task and nature of the group, and promote effective communication and teamwork.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Contributions include: maintaining good group dynamics, identifying purposes, agendas, procedures and schedules, monitoring developments and retaining focus, drawing conclusions, preparing and delivering feedback and ensuring group ownership of conclusions.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 2

Interviews successfully establish a relationship appropriate to the context, and provide a non-threatening opportunity for participants to share information.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Formal and informal; plans, background research; ordering of questions; flexibility in the situation when sequence or focus is disrupted; organisation of data elicited; and conclusions drawn.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 3

Participation in formal meetings is appropriate to the purpose and context of the meeting. Participation is consistent with meeting procedures and contributes to the achievement of meeting objectives.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Spectrum of formal meeting procedures.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 4

Participation in discussions, debates or negotiations is appropriate to the purpose and topic. Participation is consistent with the formality of procedures and contributes to meaningful interaction between participants.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Spectrum of discussion situations, informal and formal debating procedures, and procedures for negotiations and meetings.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 5

Responses to the ways others express themselves are sensitive to differing socio-cultural contexts.

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 2

Use strategies that capture and retain the interest of an audience.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1

Key words/signs, pace and pause, stress, volume and intonation or sign size, pace, rhythm and non-manual features (NMFs) are used in appropriate ways to reinforce the message.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 2

Body language is appropriate to context and topic, and reinforces main ideas and points of view.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 3

Formal communications are planned in writing/signing, and plans are detailed, complete, and realistic with respect to time allocation and content.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 4

Visual aids are appropriate to topic and context, and enhance the presentation and the transfer of information and understanding.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Cue cards, visual aids, handouts, multi-media.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 5

Techniques are used to maintain continuity and interaction.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Responding to queries, repetition of information, rewording, asking questions to check understanding, referring to cue cards; timing techniques; responsiveness to audience cues that contact is being lost, appropriate use of NMFs.

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 3

Identify and respond to manipulative use of language.

OUTCOME RANGE

News clips, summaries, political speeches/presentations, marketing material, advertisements.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA**ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1**

Facts and opinions are identified and distinguished.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 2

Omission of necessary information is noted and addressed.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 3

The implications of how the choice of language structures and features, specifically tone, register, style and point of view affect audience interpretations of spoken/signed texts are explained.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 4

Distortion of a contributor's position on a given issue is explored with specific reference to what has been selected and omitted.

UNIT STANDARD ACCREDITATION AND MODERATION OPTIONS

Accreditation Options:

- Providers of learning towards this unit standard will need to meet the accreditation requirements of the relevant ETQA.

Moderation Option:

- The moderation requirements of the relevant ETQA must be met in order to award credit to learners for this unit standard.

UNIT STANDARD ESSENTIAL EMBEDDED KNOWLEDGE

The essential embedded knowledge will be assessed through assessment of the specific outcomes in terms of the stipulated assessment criteria.

Learners can understand and explain that languages have certain features and conventions, which can be manipulated. Learners can apply this knowledge and adapt language to suit different contexts, audiences

and purposes. Knowledge of formats, conventions, protocols and contexts is acquired through activities used to attain this unit standard.

Learners are unlikely to achieve all the specific outcomes to the standards described in the assessment criteria, without knowledge of the listed embedded knowledge. This means that for the most part, the possession or lack of the knowledge can be directly inferred from the quality of the learner's performance. Where direct assessment of knowledge is required, assessment criteria have been included in the body of the unit standard.

UNIT STANDARD DEVELOPMENTAL OUTCOME

N/A

UNIT STANDARD LINKAGES

N/A

Critical Cross-field Outcomes (CCFO):

UNIT STANDARD CCFO IDENTIFYING

Identify and solve problems: using context to decode and make meaning individually and in groups in oral, reading and written or signing activities.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO WORKING

Work effectively with others and in teams: using interactive speech/signing in activities, discussion and research projects.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO ORGANISING

Organise and manage oneself and one's activities responsibly and effectively through using language.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO COLLECTING

Collect, analyse, organise and critically evaluate information: fundamental to the process of growing language capability across language applications and fields of study.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO COMMUNICATING

Communicate effectively using visual, mathematical and/or language skills: in formal and informal communications.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO DEMONSTRATING

Understand the world as a set of inter-related parts of a system: through using language to explore and express links, and exploring a global range of contexts and texts.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO CONTRIBUTING

Contribute to the full development of oneself: by engaging with texts that stimulate awareness and development of life skills and the learning process.

UNIT STANDARD ASSESSOR CRITERIA

Assessors should keep the following general principles in mind when designing and conducting assessments against this unit standard:

- Focus the assessment activities on gathering evidence in terms of the main outcome expressed in the title to ensure assessment is integrated rather than fragmented. Remember we want to declare the person competent in terms of the title. Where assessment at title level is unmanageable, then focus assessment around each specific outcome, or groups of specific outcomes.
- Make sure evidence is gathered across the entire range, wherever it applies. Assessment activities should be as close to the real performance as possible, and where simulations or role-plays are used, there should be supporting evidence to show the learner is able to perform in the real situation.
- Do not focus the assessment activities on each assessment criterion. Rather make sure the assessment activities focus on outcomes and are sufficient to enable evidence to be gathered around all the assessment criteria.

- The assessment criteria provide the specifications against which assessment judgements should be made. In most cases, knowledge can be inferred from the quality of the performances, but in other cases, knowledge and understanding will have to be tested through questioning techniques. Where this is required, there will be assessment criteria to specify the standard required.
- The task of the assessor is to gather sufficient evidence, of the prescribed type and quality, as specified in this unit standard, that the learner can achieve the outcomes again and again and again. This means assessors will have